Kassandra Hernández

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	Department of Economics, UC Berkeley	https://kasshernandez.github.io/

Research Interests

Labor Economics, Education, Immigration, Inequality, Public Policy

Education

University of California, Berkeley
Ph.D. in Economics — 2021-Present

UCLA Luskin School of Public Affairs
Master of Public Policy (MPP) — 2018-2020

Michigan State University
AEA Summer Training Program (Advanced Track) — 2020

University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA)
B.A. in Philosophy (Labor Studies minor) — 2015-2017
Summa Cum Laude · College Honors · Departmental Honors

Moorpark College
A.A. in Philosophy — 2013-2015
Dean's List · Graduation with Honors

Academic Research Experience (graduate level)

Graduate Research Fellow, UC Berkeley Labor Center — 2023-2026
Advisor: Dr. Enrique Lopezlira

Graduate Research Fellow, California Policy Lab (UCB) — 2022-2023
Advisor: Dr. Jesse Rothstein

Graduate Student Researcher, UCLA — 2019
Advisor: Dr. R. Jisung Park

Policy Research Experience

Research Analyst, UCLA Latino Policy & Politics Institute — 2021
Advisor: Dr. Rodrigo Dominguez-Villegas

Research Fellow, UCLA LPPI — 2020
Advisor: Dr. Rodrigo Dominguez-Villegas

Teaching Experience

Instructor, PPIA Summer Institute — 2024
– *Quantitative Methods* (undergraduate)

Teaching Associate, UCLA — 2019-2020
– *Using Data Science to Learn about Society* (undergraduate)
– *Information, Evidence, and Persuasion* (undergraduate)
– *Statistical Methods for Policy Analysis II* (graduate)
– *MPP Summer Math Camp* (graduate, x2)

Teaching Assistant, UCLA — 2019
– *Statistical Methods for Policy Analysis I* (graduate)
– *Research & Internships in Food Studies* (undergraduate, x2)

Working Papers

"When Constraints Bind: The Effects of the CA Dream Act Application on Undocumented Students Success," with Teresita Cruz Vital

"Worker-led Lawsuits: The Effects of California's Private Attorneys General Act on Business Behavior Across the State," with Enrique Lopezlira

Work in Progress

"Who Leads and Who Pays? Worker-led Enforcement and Differential Effects across Industries"

"Goodbye EFC, Hello SAI: How FAFSA Simplification Impacts Students' Educational and Credit Outcomes," with Hannah Case, Teresita Cruz Vital, and Steve Ramos

"Skills without the Bills? Apprenticeships, Career Technical Education, and Consumer Credit Outcomes" with Gaby Lohner and Steve Ramos

Fellowships and Awards (Graduate)

UC Office of the President, UC President's Pre-Professoriate Fellowship (UC PPPF)	2026
UC Berkeley Institute for Research on Labor & Employment, Dissertation Fellowship	2026
Wheelhouse at UC Davis, Summer Scholars Fellowship	2026
California Policy Lab, Graduate Fellowship	2024
UC Berkeley, Outstanding Graduate Organization Leadership Award	2024
The Ford Foundation, Honorable Mention	2023
UC Berkeley, Cota Robles Fellowship	2021-2023
UC Berkeley Department of Economics, Departmental Award	2021-2023
AEA Summer Training Program, Best Paper in Advanced Track	2020
UCLA Luskin School of Public Affairs, MPP Commencement Speaker	2020
UCLA Luskin, Outstanding Academic Achievement	2020
UCLA Luskin, Teaching Assistant Award	2020
UCLA Luskin, Leadership & Service Award	2020
UCLA Luskin, Graduate Fellowship	2019
UCLA Luskin, Calvin and Marilyn Gross Fellowship	2019
UCLA, UC Regents Graduate Award	2019
UCLA, Graduate Opportunity Fellowship	2018

Research Grants

W.E. Upjohn Institute & Russel Sage Foundation (RSF), 2026
– Dissertation Research Grant ($15,000)

UC Office of the President, 2026
– UC PPPF Research Grant ($10,000)

Washington Center for Equitable Growth, 2024
– Early Career Grant ($15,000)

Family Policy to Reduce Racial Inequities in Health, 2024
– Graduate Student Research Award ($30,000)
with Teresita Cruz Vital & Alessandro Marchetti-Bowick

UC Berkeley Institute for Research on Labor & Employment, 2024
– Graduate Student Research Award ($6,000)

California Policy Lab, 2023
– Seed Grant ($7,443)
with Teresita Cruz Vital

UC Berkeley Economics, 2021
– Award for Gender-Related Research ($9,000)
with Teresita Cruz Vital

Selected Presentations

"When Constraints Bind: The Effects of the CA Dream Act Application on Undocumented Students Success"
– **2024-2025 AY**: Freedom & Justice Summer Conference
– **2025-2026 AY**: UC Berkeley Department of Economics Public Finance Seminar, Labor Lunch Series, Labor Mini Symposium; Western Economic Association International (WAEI) Annual Meeting
– **2026-2027 AY**: Growing Our Own: A Graduate Research Symposium, UC Davis; Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Meeting (Planned)

"Worker-led Lawsuits: The Effects of California's Private Attorneys General Act on Business Behavior Across the State"
– **2024-2025 AY**: American Economic Association Summer Mentoring Pipeline Conference; Freedom & Justice Summer Conference; Allied Social Science Associations (ASSA) Annual Meeting; Labor & Employment Relations Association (LERA)
– **2025-2026 AY**: Institute for Research on Poverty (IRP) Summer Research Workshop
– **2026-2027** AY (Planned): UC Berkeley IRLE Scholars Meeting; UC Berkeley Department of Economics Labor Lunch Series

Policy Publications

"Demographic and Job Characteristics of Baltimore's Security Guard Workforce" (2026). UC Berkeley Labor Center. – with Enrique Lopezlira & Nari Rhee
Note: Complementary work also considers the security guard workforce in: Seattle and Washington; California; United States

"Highlighting the Diversity of California's Asian American and Pacific Islander Workforce" (2025). UC Berkeley Labor Center.

"Who are California's American Indian and Alaska Native Low-wage Workers?" (2024). UC Berkeley Labor Center.

Latinas Exiting the Workforce: How the Pandemic Revealed Historic Disadvantages and Heightened Economic Hardship (2021). UCLA Latino Policy & Politics Institute (LPPI). –with Diana Garcia, Paula Nazario, Michael Rios, & Rodrigo Dominguez-Villegas

A Path to Prosperity: The Macroeconomic Benefits of Four Immigrant Regularization Scenarios (2021). UCLA LPPI. –with Raúl Hinojosa-Ojeda, Sherman Robinson, Marcelo Pleitez, Rodrigo Dominguez-Villegas, & Abel Valenzuela, Jr.

Disparities in the Distribution of Paycheck Protection Program Funds in California's Congressional Districts (2021). UCLA LPPI. –with Paul M. Ong, Silvia R. Gonzalez, Rodrigo Dominguez-Villegas, Jonathan Ong, & Chhandara Pech.

Vote Choice of Latino Voters in the 2020 Presidential Election (2021). UCLA LPPI. –with Rodrigo Dominguez-Villegas, Nick Gonzalez, Angela Gutierrez, Michael Herndon, Ana Oaxaca, Michael Rios, Marcel Roman, Tye Rush, & Daisy Vera.

Disparities in the Distribution of Paycheck Protection Program Funds Between Majority-White Neighborhoods and Neighborhoods of Color in California (2020). UCLA LPPI. –with Silvia R. Gonzalez, Paul M. Ong, Chhandara Pech, & Rodrigo Dominguez-Villegas.

Media Coverage & Interviews

English: Associated Press (AP) News; Forbes; The Hill; KPCC–NPR News; Washington Post; USA Today; ABC News; Milwaukee PBS; Voice of America
Spanish: Telemundo; Univision–Los Angeles; Milwaukee PBS

Professional Activities & Affiliations

US Census Bureau: Special Sworn Status
American Society for Hispanic Economists (ASHE)
American Economic Association, Committee on the Status of Minority Groups in the Economics Profession (CSMGEP)
Association for Economic Research of Indigenous Peoples (AERIP)
AEA Summer Program Alumni (Advanced Track)

Professional Development

Economics of Migration Summer Institute, UC Davis	2023
Stone Center Summer Institute on Inequality, UC Berkeley	2023
Path to the Professoriate Program, Office of Graduate Diversity	2021-2022

Service

Graduate Research Mentor, Social Sciences Research Pathways	2024-Present
Invited Panelist, Undergraduate Women in Economics at Berkeley	2026
Graduate Student Admission Review Committee, BEE	2023-2026
Graduate Mentor, Getting Into Graduate School	2023-2026
Leader, DEI Faculty Recruitment, BEE	2024-2025
Co-President, Economists for Equity at Berkeley (BEE)	2023-2024
Invited Speaker: MPP & Beyond, PPIA Junior Summer Institute	2023
Committee Member/Doctoral Mentor, BEE Mentoring Program	2022-2023
Student Liason, Emerging Scholars Reading Group	2022-2023
Co-Leader, DEI Faculty Recruitment, BEE	2022-2023
Organizing Member, UCLA Luskin Admission Review Committee	2018-2019
Lead Convener, Kern Food Policy Council Working Groups	2017-2018
AmeriCorps VISTA (placed at CSU Bakersfield)	2017-2018

Languages

English (fluent); Spanish (native)

Skills

Programming: Stata, R, SAS, LaTeX
Policy: Reports, memos, briefs & blogs; media coverage (print, radio, television)
Teaching: Content creation, instruction, management, grading, & 1-on-1 research guidance of graduate and undergraduate students

CV Updated: October 27, 2026